

FREE PATTERN

Free Half Double Crochet Scarf Pattern for Beginners

A thicker, softer, faster-working scarf using one stitch taller than our single crochet version.

Updated 2026 • US terms • 7in / 18cm wide, any length



If you've already made our [single crochet scarf](#), this version uses the same one-row-repeated structure, just with half double crochet instead. The taller stitch produces a softer, more drapey fabric and works up noticeably faster for the same finished length.

MATERIALS

- 3–4 skeins worsted-weight yarn (about 500–600 yards total)
- 5.5mm (US size I) crochet hook
- Scissors
- Yarn needle, for weaving in ends

ABBREVIATIONS (US TERMS)

ABBR.

MEANS

ch	Chain
hdc	Half double crochet
st(s)	Stitch(es)

New to abbreviations? Our [abbreviations glossary](#) covers US and UK terms side by side.



Crochet hook with yarn for half double crochet

GAUGE

12 hdc and 10 rows measures about 4in / 10cm square with a 5.5mm hook and worsted yarn. Gauge isn't critical here; a scarf is forgiving on exact width.

NOTES

- Written in US terms. Check our [abbreviations glossary](#) first if you usually work in UK terms.
- Half double crochet uses about a third less yarn length per row than single crochet, so this scarf finishes faster for the same length.

- Stop whenever the scarf reaches your desired length, typically 60–70in / 150–180cm for an adult.

Quick comparison: hdc vs sc scarf

	SINGLE CROCHET	HALF DOUBLE CROCHET
Fabric	Dense, firm	Softer, more drape
Speed	Slower	Roughly 30% faster
Best hook	5.0mm	5.5mm

Pattern

FOUNDATION

Chain 21.

ROW 1

Hdc in the 3rd chain from the hook, and in each chain across. Turn. *(19 sts)*

ROW 2 AND ALL FOLLOWING ROWS

Ch 2 (counts as first hdc), hdc in each stitch across. Turn. *(19 sts)*

Repeat this row until the scarf reaches your desired length. Check your stitch count every few rows — it should stay at 19 throughout.

FINISHING

Fasten off, leaving a 6in / 15cm tail. Weave in all ends with a yarn needle.

Frequently asked questions

What is the difference between a single crochet and half double crochet scarf?

Half double crochet is a taller stitch than single crochet, producing a thicker, softer, more drapey fabric and working up roughly 30% faster for the same length, since fewer rows are needed.

Is half double crochet harder to learn than single crochet?

Not significantly. It adds one extra motion (yarn over before inserting the hook) compared to single crochet, which most beginners pick up within the first few stitches of practice.

How much yarn do I need for a half double crochet scarf?

A standard adult scarf in half double crochet uses roughly 500 to 600 yards of worsted-weight yarn, slightly less than the same length in single crochet since the stitch is taller and faster.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.